

Denmark



Denmark occupies the Jutland peninsula and over 400 islands in southern Scandinavia. Greenland and the Faeroe Islands are self-governing associated territories.



GEOGRAPHY

Fertile farmland covers two-thirds of the terrain, which is among the flattest in the world. About 100 islands are inhabited.



CLIMATE

Damp, temperate climate with mild summers and cold, wet winters. Rainfall is moderate.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Income distribution is the most even in the West: society is egalitarian with few tensions. Cultural clashes have arisen with immigrant minorities. Almost all women now work and Denmark is a world leader in childcare provision. Marriage is becoming less common, even for couples with children.



INSIGHT: Denmark is Europe's oldest kingdom – the monarchy dates back to the 10th century



THE ECONOMY

Natural gas and oil reserves. Skilled workforce key to high-tech industrial success. Pork, bacon, dairy products are exported. Opted not to join the euro, though its currency is pegged.



FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Kingdom of Denmark

DATE OF FORMATION: 950

CAPITAL: Copenhagen

POPULATION: 5.47 million

TOTAL AREA: 16,639 sq. miles
(43,094 sq. km)

DENSITY: 334 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: Danish

RELIGIONS: Evangelical Lutheran 89%, other 10%, Roman Catholic 1%

ETHNIC MIX: Danish 96%, other (including Scandinavian and Turkish) 3%, Faeroese and Inuit 1%

GOVERNMENT: Parliamentary system

CURRENCY: Danish krone = 100 øre